

Making it to the Big League

Thanks to my unusually long winning streak for the last couple of years, people in corporate circles began to hear my name. By that, I mean executives on the treasury side, such as chief financial officers. I found some of the fund managers too becoming more approachable now. Thankfully, since most of my gains came from my trading bets and not investment bets (which could be easily tracked from publicly available data), I was unknown to the media. I was perfectly fine with that since I had no desire to be known beyond my professional circles. I slowly began to get invites to parties of the rich and famous, which I refused without a second thought. Promoters began to send feelers to me to help boost their share price in return for a cut. At times, there would be offers to hammer a rival company's shares. I had been approached in the past too with such requests, but the pedigree of companies that were now seeking my services was a few notches higher.

I have helped quite a few promoters to ramp up their stock prices, but as a rule I never invest in their shares. I have to trade in their stock for a certain period when I am managing its price, but my association with the stock ceases once I have fulfilled my commitment to them. It is good if promoters are mindful of their stock price; that way they may not want to do something rash that will upset the market or their key shareholders. But it is a problem if promoters are obsessed with their stock price. To me it is a clear indication that they are not focusing their time and energy on their main business. And that is a recipe for disaster. Promoters often forget that a healthy share price flows from the strength of their core business and not